

Doctorly Intro Call — Answers & Questions

For: Bongani Nyoni · **Call:** Introductory call with Loic · Google Meet · Thursday 16:00
This call is to get to know you — your story, why doctorly, and whether you fit. It is *not* the technical test. Keep answers honest, warm, and simple.

How to use this: read each answer out loud a few times so it sounds natural — not memorised. The words are simple on purpose. Change anything so it sounds like you.

Part 1 — Questions they may ask, and what to say

"Tell me about yourself."

Say: "I'm Bongani, a senior .NET developer based in Cape Town, with over eight years' experience. I started out building business systems in Zimbabwe, then moved into South African fintech. For the last four years I've focused on regulated financial software — KYC, client lifecycle management, and transfer agency. First at Fenergo, where I built compliance features for big banks like Bank of Montreal, ANZ and Standard Chartered, and now at Sonata ONE as a senior developer leading backend design. My strength is building secure systems that handle sensitive, regulated data. I'm now looking for a remote role with a product company where I can keep growing toward architecture — and that's what brought me to doctorly."

"Why doctorly? Why this role?"

Say: "Three reasons. First, the domain fits me. doctorly builds regulated healthcare software — sensitive patient data, strict rules, many users. That's the same shape of problem I've worked on for years in financial KYC, just in healthcare. Second, it's a real product used by real doctors, and it's fully remote, which is what I want next. Third, the engineering is interesting — like letting many people edit the same patient record safely, keeping data secure, and moving practices off old systems. I enjoy hard problems in serious domains." *(Add one honest, personal sentence here — it's the part that stops this sounding rehearsed.)*

"Why are you thinking of leaving Sonata ONE?"

Say: "It's not about running away. I've learned a lot there and I'm grateful. But I want a fully remote role with a product company, and more room to grow into architecture-level work. doctorly looks like that next step." *(Stay positive — never criticise your current employer.)*

"Tell me about what you do now."

Say: "At Sonata ONE I'm a senior .NET developer working on transfer-agency and private-markets systems. Day to day I design and build backend systems, using CQRS with MediatR and separate read models to keep things clean and fast. I work in an agile team, take part in code reviews, mentor junior developers, and I often build new systems from the ground up."

"What do you know about doctorly, and why do you want to work in HealthTech?"

Say: "You're a Berlin-based company building cloud software for German doctors' practices. You move them off old desktop systems to a modern cloud system where staff can work on the same patient record at the same time, and you handle moving their data across from the old software. It's a heavily regulated space — GDPR and German healthcare rules — which is part of what makes it interesting to me. I also noticed you have a team in Cape Town, which caught my eye. As for why HealthTech — I've spent years making regulated financial systems safer and better, and HealthTech is a place where that same skill genuinely improves people's lives. Helping doctors spend less time on admin and more time with patients feels like meaningful work, and the engineering problems are serious. That mix of purpose and hard problems is what draws me."

"What are you looking for in your next role?"

Say: "Three things: a product I can care about in a serious domain; a strong engineering culture with code reviews, pairing, and people who care about quality; and a clear path to grow into architecture and system design. Remote-first with a good team is where I do my best work."

"How do you feel about working in a highly regulated industry?"

Say: "I'm very comfortable in it — it's where I've spent the last four years. Regulation means audit trails, strict data rules, and careful change control, and I actually like that discipline because it makes you build things properly. So a regulated domain isn't a hurdle for me, it's one of my strengths — and it's a big part of why doctorly fits."

"Do you prefer a fast-paced startup or an established corporate structure?"

Say: "I've spent most of my career in established companies and banks, so I know how to work with structure, process and compliance. But I'm drawn to a faster, product-focused environment like doctorly — more ownership, building things end to end, and seeing the impact quickly. What I'd bring is the discipline from regulated corporate work, with the energy and ownership of a startup. I think that combination fits well here."

"You've worked with sensitive data — tell me about that."

Say: "Yes. For the last four years almost all my work has been on regulated software in finance — KYC, client lifecycle management, loan origination. That means secure systems, audit trails, strict rules on how data is handled, and not being able to just change data freely. At Fenargo I built compliance features for major banks. Healthcare is regulated in a different way — GDPR and German healthcare rules instead of KYC — but the way you think about sensitive data, audit and compliance is the same, so I'd settle in quickly."

Tip: "Regulated software" is one of your strongest cards — use the phrase. But don't claim to know the German healthcare rules yet (GDPR, the Telematikinfrastruktur, KBV billing). Say the thinking transfers and you'll pick up the specific rules quickly. Claiming knowledge you don't have is the one way this can backfire.

"Have you worked remotely or with distributed teams?"

Say: "Yes. I'm comfortable working with teams in different places, communicating clearly in writing, and managing my own time. Cape Town and Berlin are on the same clock right now, so working hours line up well."

"What's your cloud experience?"

Say: "Strong, on both AWS and Azure. At Fenargo I worked on both their products — Fen-E, the on-prem solution, and Fen-X, their cloud SaaS platform. On Fen-X I did integration architecture using AWS — services like API Gateway, Lambda, S3 and SQS/SNS to connect external systems into the platform. I also went deep on AWS networking: I designed VPC subnets using IPv6 and wrote an internal article on it, because AWS had started charging for public IPv4 addresses, so moving to IPv6 saved real cost. And I built ETL pipelines to move data into Fen-X using Azure services like Azure Data Factory. So I know your AWS stack well, and I think about cloud design — and cost — the same way across providers."

***Tip:** Keep the AWS service list to what you actually used — adjust it. The IPv6-instead-of-IPv4 cost story is a great, current detail (AWS began charging for public IPv4 addresses in 2024), so tell it with confidence — it shows architecture thinking and cost awareness.*

"Have you worked on a cloud SaaS or multi-tenant product before?"

Say: "Yes. Fen-X at Fenargo was a cloud SaaS platform for KYC and client lifecycle management — a regulated, multi-tenant cloud product, which is very close in shape to what doctorly is building. I did integration architecture on it using AWS, so I understand what a regulated cloud product needs: tenant isolation, secure data, and clean integration with other systems."

"Can you walk me through your experience with C#/.NET Core and modern frontend frameworks like React?"

Say: "C# and .NET are my core — over eight years. I build backend systems with ASP.NET Core and Entity Framework, using patterns like CQRS with MediatR and Clean Architecture, which is most of my senior work now. On the frontend I've worked with React and Redux, as well as Angular, and TypeScript, so I can build and integrate the UI side too. My centre of gravity is backend and architecture, but I'm genuinely full-stack and happy to cross over when a feature needs it."

"What's your experience with cloud-native architecture, containerisation (Docker) and CI/CD?"

Say: "Good experience across all three. I use Docker and Kubernetes to containerise and run services. For CI/CD I've used Jenkins and Azure DevOps to build, test and deploy — preparing release packages and running deployments. And I design backend services with scalability in mind: small, well-bounded services, configuration kept separate, health checks, and logging and monitoring built in. I know your stack uses GitLab CI and AWS, and those ideas carry straight over for me."

"Do you focus more on backend or frontend?"

Say: "I'm full-stack, but my strength and my focus is backend — .NET, system design, APIs, data and architecture. That's where most of my senior work sits, including the CQRS and read-model work at Sonata ONE. I'm comfortable on the frontend too, with React, Angular and TypeScript, so I can work across the stack when a feature needs it. But if you're asking where I add the most value, it's backend."

Tip: *This role is backend .NET-focused, so leaning backend is the right call — being honestly full-stack on top is a bonus, not a worry.*

"What's your notice period? When could you start?"

Say: "One calendar month. So about a month after we agree terms."

"What is your earliest possible start date?"

Say: "I'm on one calendar month's notice, so once we agree terms I could start about a month later. If timing matters on your side, I'm happy to work back from a date that suits you."

"What are your salary expectations?"

Say: "I've looked at the market for senior .NET developers. I'm flexible depending on how the package is put together, but I'm looking in the region of [YOUR RAND RANGE — see Part 3] a year. I'd also like to understand how you handle pay and share options for someone based in South Africa. What range did you have in mind for this role?" (*If you can, let them say a number first.*)

"Do you speak German?"

Say: "Not yet, but I'd happily start learning, since the product is for German doctors. My understanding is that many Berlin engineering teams work in English day to day — is that the case here?"

"Tell me about a project you're proud of."

Say: "At Sonata ONE I reworked how we handled a document structure — moving it from a flat layout to a proper hierarchy, and lining up the read side using CQRS. It made the system easier to maintain and faster to read from. The careful part was doing it safely, because the data was sensitive and we couldn't afford mistakes. I'm proud of how cleanly we landed it."

"Tell me about a complex project or backend feature you owned from start to finish."

Say: "A good example is a Transfer of Interest feature I owned on the transfer-agency platform. A Transfer of Interest is when an investor moves their holding in a fund to another party — it's a complex, regulated workflow that touches compliance and KYC checks, approvals, and generating the right legal documents. I owned it end to end: the design, the backend build, and the integration. I used CQRS with MediatR and dedicated read models to keep the command and query sides clean. A big part of it was the document solution — generating and storing the legal documents tied to each transfer, with the audit trail you need in a regulated system. The hard part was getting the

workflow and the data model right so it was correct, traceable and maintainable. I'm proud of it because it was real end-to-end ownership of a regulated feature — exactly the kind of work I'd want to do at doctorly."

Tip: *This is the answer they'll dig into most — keep the details to what you actually did and can defend if they ask follow-ups. The document-tree story above and this Transfer of Interest story are two different examples, so you can use one for "proud of" and this one for "owned end to end."*

"How would your colleagues describe you?"

Say: "As steady and reliable, someone who takes ownership and helps others. I mentor junior developers, I care about code quality, and I like to understand the business goal before I jump into code."

"Why should we hire you / what's your strength?"

Say: "My strength is building regulated, sensitive-data systems cleanly. I've done it for years in finance, I lead backend design, and I care about doing it properly — audit, quality, and maintainability. That's exactly what healthcare software needs."

"Do you have any side projects or open-source contributions?"

Say: "Yes. At work, a side project I've taken on is automating our API testing using Robot Framework — building a Python-based test automation suite so our testing is faster and more reliable. Outside of work, most of my time goes into my studies — I'm doing a second honours degree, in Computer Engineering, part-time, which I manage around my full-time job without it affecting my delivery. So I'm always learning and building."

Tip: *The work automation shows initiative beyond your assigned tickets, and the part-time degree shows discipline — both are good signals for a remote team. Be honest about open source rather than overclaiming. (You can also mention Ikamva Tech Lab here if you'd like.)*

Part 2 — Questions for you to ask (recite these)

Pick 4 or 5. Asking good questions is part of how they judge you.

- "Can you tell me more about the team I'd be joining, and how big it is?"
 - "I saw you have a team in Cape Town — how is that set up, and would I be part of it?"
 - "What's the biggest engineering challenge doctorly is working on right now?"
 - "How much does the German regulation side shape the day-to-day work?"
 - "What does your code review and pairing culture look like day to day?"
 - "What would success in this role look like in the first six months?"
 - "Is there room to grow toward architecture and system design?"
 - "How do you handle pay and share options for someone based in South Africa?"
 - "What do the next steps look like after this call?"
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Part 3 — Quick facts to have ready

Notice period: one calendar month.

Time zone: Cape Town and Berlin are both UTC+2 right now, so 16:00 is the same for both of you. Check the invite to be sure.

Salary (decide your number before the call) — quote in Rands, since you'd be based in SA: - Your current package is about **R105,000 a month (~R1.26 million a year)** — treat that as the floor you want to beat. - A reasonable ask is around **R1.4-R1.7 million a year** (about R117,000-R142,000 a month), said as "flexible depending on structure." - If they talk in euros, that's roughly **€75,000-€90,000** at today's rate (~R18.8 per euro) — so you're not caught off guard. - Ask two things: how they structure pay (local employee, contractor, or employer-of-record), and how share options work for a South-Africa-based hire. - This is market context, not financial advice — decide your own number before the call.

doctorly values: Kindness, Excellence, Ownership, Integrity. Try to show these naturally.

Their stack matches yours: C#/.NET Core, Entity Framework, PostgreSQL, React, TypeScript, Docker, Kubernetes, GitLab, AWS. Good news — you don't need to oversell anything.

What happens after this call: technical interview (~1 hr) → an assessment task (2-4 hrs) → reference checks → meet-the-team interview → contract walkthrough. The whole process is meant to take under two weeks.

Before the call — checklist

- [] Said "tell me about yourself" out loud at least three times
- [] "Why doctorly" ready, with one honest personal line
- [] Salary range and notice period clear in your head
- [] 4-5 questions chosen from Part 2
- [] Tested Google Meet link, camera and mic
- [] Quiet space, good light, water nearby
- [] Short notes on screen to glance at (don't read word for word)
- [] Looked up Loic on LinkedIn